Help New Caregivers Know Your Wife, Not Just Her Chart

Four prompts to gather her routines in her own words, pull out what new caregivers need on day one, keep her preferences separate from her care orders, and draft a short About Me page to hand over.

Where you are

Your wife is moving into a new care setting this week, or new caregivers are about to start coming to the house. You know she takes her tea before anything else and can't stand being called “sweetie.” They don't, and you can't be there every hour to tell them.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not diagnose, assess safety, or decide. Bring clinical questions to a clinician, and call emergency services for an emergency.

What you'll have at the end

You can hand the new team a page that tells them who she is and what makes a day go well for her, with her wishes and her medical instructions kept clearly apart.

A one-page About Me draft: How to address me, My mornings and evenings, Food I like and food I'm told to avoid, What I enjoy and who matters to me, How to talk with me, and What helps when I'm unsettled.

Before you start

- Ten minutes with your wife, if she's able, asking her what a good day looks like.
- Her usual mornings and evenings as you know them.
- Any dietary restriction or allergy a clinician has given you in writing. If you only have the first one, start there.

PROMPT 1

Start with her own account of a good day

WHY THIS MATTERS

The fastest way to end up with your version of her preferences is to skip asking her. Even a short conversation, even one with gaps, puts her voice at the center of the page.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Notes from asking your wife about a good day, in her words as much as possible. If she couldn't answer everything, note that too.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> I asked my wife to describe a good day and what she would want new caregivers to know about her. Here is what she said, as close to her words as I could get, plus a few things she couldn't answer or I had to fill in:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Organize this under: WHAT SHE SAID IN HER OWN WORDS, WHAT I ADDED, and WHAT WE DIDN'T GET TO. Keep her phrasing wherever I gave it to you. Mark anything in the second section that I'm not certain she would agree with. Then give me three gentle follow-up questions I could ask her tomorrow, in a way that doesn't feel like a form.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

How much of the page is in her voice versus yours.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Ask the follow-up questions when she's rested, and add what she says.

PROMPT 2

Pull out what the new caregivers need on day one

WHY THIS MATTERS

A new caregiver has about two minutes for your page. The small things that keep her steady in a strange place, when she wakes, what she drinks first, which side of the bed, are the ones that get lost in a move.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Her usual morning, mealtime, and evening routines, and anything that helps her settle somewhere unfamiliar.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here are my wife's daily routines and the things that help her feel settled when she is somewhere new:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Go through them and pick out the details a new caregiver would need in the first day or two. Group them as: FIRST THING IN THE MORNING, MEALS, DURING THE DAY, WINDING DOWN AT NIGHT, and IF SHE SEEMS UNSETTLED. Write each as one short, concrete line, such as what she

> drinks first or how she likes to be woken. Set aside anything that is nice to know but not urgent in a separate list called LATER. Don't add routines I haven't described.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Lines a stranger could act on without asking you.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Read it back to her, or to whoever knows her mornings best, and fix what's wrong.

PROMPT 3

Keep her preferences separate from her care orders

WHY THIS MATTERS

“She doesn't like fish” and “she has a nut allergy” are both about food, but one is a preference and the other is an instruction from a clinician. If they sit in the same list, staff may treat both as optional or both as orders.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Her food likes and dislikes, plus anything about diet, swallowing, or allergies that a doctor, nurse, or dietitian has told you.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is everything I know about what my wife eats and drinks, including her likes and dislikes and anything clinicians have told us about her diet, swallowing, or allergies:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Sort it into two clearly separate lists. First: FOOD AND DRINK SHE PREFERS, in her own terms. Second: RESTRICTIONS AND INSTRUCTIONS FROM CLINICIANS, with who gave each one and when, if I said. If something could be either, put it under NEEDS CHECKING WITH THE CARE TEAM. Do not add any restriction I didn't mention, do not suggest changes to her diet, and do not turn a preference into a rule.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Anything that landed in NEEDS CHECKING. Those go to the nurse, not onto the About Me page.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Confirm the restrictions list against the written instructions you have, and ask the care team about anything uncertain.

PROMPT 4

Draft the About Me page

WHY THIS MATTERS

Now you have her words, the day-one details, and the preferences kept apart from the orders. The last step is making it short enough that it actually gets read.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The results of the first three prompts.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Below is what I've collected to introduce my wife to her new caregivers:
>
> [PASTE THE RESULTS OF PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> Write a one-page About Me draft in her voice, using “I” where I've given you her own words and “she” where I filled in. Use these headings: HOW TO ADDRESS ME, MY MORNINGS AND EVENINGS, FOOD I LIKE AND FOOD I'M TOLD TO AVOID (keep the two apart), WHAT I ENJOY AND WHO MATTERS TO ME, HOW TO TALK WITH ME, and WHAT HELPS WHEN I'M UNSETTLED. Keep every line short. Leave space at the bottom for who wrote this, the date, and who it was given to. Do not include medication details or care instructions; those stay with the care team.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A page you would be comfortable having her read.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Show it to her if she's able, ask who should receive it, and bring it with you on the first day.

Carry it into a full profile

The About Me page covers who she is. The care interview adds what she needs, who supports her, and what the care team has said, so the new caregivers get one Family Care Profile instead of a page here and a form there.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›